Rubric bachelor’s thesis: social media and sleep quality

University, BSc Psychology. Assessment: grade 1 to 10 per criterion. The final grade is the weighted average.

Note for the marker. Assess at the level of a bachelor’s thesis. The design is cross-sectional and correlational: causal conclusions (“causes”, “leads to”) are therefore not allowed and should weigh heavily under criterion 5. Check whether the number of participants is consistent across the method, tables and text; unexplained differences are an error under criterion 3 or 4.

Criterion	1 to 3	4 and 5	6 and 7	8 to 10
1. Introduction and hypotheses (15%)	No research question or no theoretical basis.	Literature discussed, but the hypotheses do not follow logically or are not testable.	Clear problem statement, relevant literature, testable hypotheses that follow from theory.	As for 6 and 7, plus a clear gap in the literature that this study addresses.
2. Method: design and instruments (15%)	Method missing or not replicable.	Design and instruments described, but reliability or operationalisation missing.	Replicable design, validated instruments with reliability, clear procedure.	As for 6 and 7, plus justification of choices and a pre-specified analysis plan.
3. Sample and data handling (10%)	No information on participants.	Participants described, but recruitment, attrition or exclusion unclear or inconsistent.	Recruitment, inclusion and exclusion, and attrition described; numbers are consistent throughout.	As for 6 and 7, plus a discussion of representativeness and power.
4. Analysis and results (20%)	No analyses or incorrect analyses.	Appropriate analysis, but incomplete reporting (for example no effect size) or interpretation within the results.	Appropriate analyses, fully reported in APA style, with a clear table.	As for 6 and 7, plus checks of assumptions and additional analyses where useful.
5. Discussion (25%)	No discussion, or only a repeat of the results.	Results interpreted, but conclusions go beyond what the design allows (such as causal claims) or limitations are missing.	Interpretation in line with the design, linked to the literature, main limitations discussed.	As for 6 and 7, plus alternative explanations, implications and concrete further research.
6. Academic writing and APA (15%)	Unreadable or without referencing.	Readable, but frequently careless in language or APA.	Clear academic English, APA largely correct, complete abstract.	Virtually error-free, consistent APA, precise wording.